



PROGRESS REPORT

Digital divides: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-26

Edition of 2026-08-26 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

38 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

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Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Universal-service programme for low-density areas	BASELINE NOT HELD	1,400 areas reached; no target, budget or completion date	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Angola

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Commercial satellite access programme	Did not exist	A commercial access hub opened in December 2025, 37 firms in the integration process by April 2026, and a first startup licensed to resell access	ADVANCED
Universal service fund	On statute since 2010 and funded by 1% of telecom operators' gross revenue, with no accounts published	Unchanged; the fund and its 1% levy remain on statute, it may make non-repayable grants for non-commercial universal-service expansion but is barred from subsidising operating costs, and no accounts, grant or disbursement have been published for any year	NO CHANGE
Satellite connectivity programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Six universities and more than 300 localities where mobile operators are absent, with 20,000 students stated, against 27 locations and about 366,000 citizens stated to a UN body in November 2025	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Benin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital usage growth	BASELINE NOT HELD	Rising usage in the regulator's 2025 report, with no disaggregation by gender or rurality	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Botswana

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
BTC Community Wi-Fi, Old Naledi	A single site, tariffs P2 to P10 plus a free 45-minute daily window (2025-06)	The same single site; no second site recorded to 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
Universal Access and Service Fund school digital centres	BASELINE NOT HELD	P1.45m and P1.5m per site, thirty machines each; no programme total or school target published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Burkina Faso

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Sahel connectivity project	Running, serving more than 3,650 users across two countries including host communities and refugees	The project report published, with US\$1.2m contributed by one European state, a vendor supplying access points and another agency training local teams	CLOSED
Digital programme for girls and women	BASELINE NOT HELD	A EUR 2.25m grant from 2021 to 2025, recorded closed, with no evaluation, outturn or beneficiary count in the base	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Real fourth-generation coverage	BASELINE NOT HELD	Fell from 53% to 33% on insecurity	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Urban and rural internet access gap	BASELINE NOT HELD	Internet access at about 72% urban against about 27% rural	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Burundi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Rural coverage target	Baseline not held	80% territorial coverage targeted; no achieved figure on file	BASELINE NOT HELD

Cameroon

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Bridging the digital gender divide project	EUR 3m committed, active	EUR 3m committed, active; no dated progress, output or Cameroon-side figure recorded in the window	NO CHANGE
Rural connectivity component of the national connectivity project	BASELINE NOT HELD	FCFA 55bn; 328 unserved localities targeted by 2028 in two phases of 120 sites plus an optional 208, with works expected by 2026-12-30	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Central African Republic

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Satellite retail service affordability	Did not exist; no licence and no service	Commercial service since 2026-03-16 at FCFA 33,000 a month plus tax, with a standard kit at FCFA 240,000; the monthly price is about 136% of monthly income per head against an international affordability threshold of 2%	ADVANCED

Comoros

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Mobile science caravans	Nothing held at the window's opening; announced 2026-01-24 as five mobile caravans covering about ninety rural localities a year	Launch under way, with no caravan count, route or start date confirmed since	ADVANCED

Congo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Mobile-internet market observatory	BASELINE NOT HELD	3.757m mobile-internet subscribers at December 2024, up 9.4%, on FCFA 63.569bn of revenue and 90.904bn megabytes of traffic at a weighted FCFA 0.70 a megabyte, against an over-15 population of 3.738m	Baseline not held

Cote d'Ivoire

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Feature-phone service platform	Did not exist	Unchanged; nothing on file establishes the launch happened, and the stated date passed	STALLED
Territorial mobile-network coverage	82% of the territory covered, with about 500 localities being connected	About 95% of the territory covered	ADVANCED
Sex-disaggregated digital access and use	81.38% of men against 47.19% of women owning a mobile phone, a 34-point gap, on 2017 fieldwork	Unchanged; nothing sex-disaggregated has been published since, so the only measurement of the gap is nine years old	NO CHANGE
Smartphone penetration	BASELINE NOT HELD	41% of the population, against a stated ambition of 80% by 2030	Baseline not held
Urban and rural internet penetration gap	BASELINE NOT HELD	52.7% urban against 24.6% rural, and household access 85.7% urban against 57.7% rural, on figures attributed to the ITU data hub	Baseline not held

DR Congo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Universal service fund pilot sites	The fund created by law in November 2020 and, per a named civil-society officer, still not available	Subsidy conventions signed with four operators for a first tranche of 40 localities (about 258,000 people), reported in an August 2026 ministry communique that puts the country's passive infrastructure at fewer than 5,500 towers against an estimated need of at least 30,000; a national diagnostic published 2026-08-07 finds nearly 3,000 uncovered localities (about 4.3m people) against national coverage of 77% 2G, 68% 3G and 57% 4G (September 2025); a second phase of 300 sites (about 1.8m people) is planned, with a 2030 target of 3,000 localities, 16m people and 100 digital community centres; the phase-0 sites were drawn from the four operators' own proposals, ten each	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Population without mobile coverage	Baseline not held	About 4.3 million people in nearly 3,000 localities without mobile coverage; national 2G coverage 77%, 3G 68% and 4G 57%, ranging from about 98% in Kinshasa to 14% in Tshuapa and 28% in each of Kwango and Sud-Ubangi (2026-08-07)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Egypt

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Presidential initiative on digital accessibility of government websites	The base carries no accessibility tooling or standard before this date	A toolbar on every page of the ministry site offering screen-reader compatibility, keyboard-only navigation, text enlargement, contrast switching, font and line-spacing changes, reading-focus highlighting, animation suppression, cursor enlargement and link highlighting, executed by the ministry's academy for persons with disabilities, whose mandate is to propagate the standards to other government bodies	BASELINE NOT HELD

Eritrea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Active mobile connections (DataReportal)	793,000 connections, 22.2% of population, 48.0% broadband (early 2025)	859,000 connections, 23.7% of population, 49.3% broadband (late 2025), +8.2% year on year	ADVANCED, MARGINAL

Eswatini

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Community innovation hubs	One hub, at Pigg's Peak	Two hubs; a third planned for the Shiselweni Region	ADVANCED

Ethiopia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Makatet refugee-inclusion framework	Did not exist	Covers 1.1m refugees and 2m internally displaced people	ADVANCED
Universal Access Fund levy	Did not exist	About 2.5bn birr a year from Ethio Telecom and Safaricom	ADVANCED
Rural mobile-internet gender gap	BASELINE NOT HELD	81% in rural areas against 29% urban (2026-03)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Ghana

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
American-funded digital inclusion and connectivity programming	In delivery	Planned and running work slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down, with no replacement funder named	REGRESSED
Women micro-entrepreneurs' use of mobile for business	Did not exist	Women micro-entrepreneurs are 14% less likely than men to use a mobile phone for business and 17% less likely to use one across three or more business use cases, with affordability of data, low perceived value, weak digital skills and confidence, and limited access to internet-enabled handsets named as the binding barriers	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Household survey of digital access	A 2019 regulator household survey, with a biennial repeat stated as intent	No repeat round; 16.8% of households with internet access against 73.8% owning a television, 7.9% of people aged five and over owning a computer of any kind, and smartphone ownership at 58.4% urban against 28.1% rural	NO CHANGE
Fourth-generation coverage against usage	BASELINE NOT HELD	Fourth-generation networks reach more than 90% of the population while actual usage runs below 60%, with many users still on feature phones	Baseline not held
Rural telephony and digital inclusion project	BASELINE NOT HELD	Continuing, with the fund restating it as top priority and taking an upgraded mast design	Baseline not held
Universal access fund	BASELINE NOT HELD	Still operating as the universal-access fund with the rural telephony project its stated top priority, and slated for conversion	Baseline not held
Young Africa Innovates community scouting programme	Did not exist	12,000 young innovators identified through community scouting rather than online applications, against a 5,000 target, working through chiefs, women's groups and disability advocates across all 16 regions and funded by a foundation under its Young Africa Works programme; the implementing agency's own review argues that digital-only outreach systematically misses rural, female and disabled innovators, against youth unemployment of 22.5% among 15-35s in the fourth quarter of 2024	BASELINE NOT HELD

Guinea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Mobile internet cost	Baseline not held	Down 25% over 2025, ministry-reported (2026-01)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Guinea-Bissau

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Internet penetration rate	32.5% internet penetration (Jan 2025)	32.5% internet penetration - no fresher measurement held within the window	NO CHANGE

Kenya

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
American-funded digital inclusion and connectivity programming	In delivery, including work in remote counties	Planned and running work slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down, with no replacement funder named	REGRESSED
EmpowerHer	Baseline not held	Trainer-of-trainers cohorts opened in Nairobi on 19 August 2026 for a first 100 women instructors and in Nyandarua on 24 to 26 August 2026, taking the accelerator into the second of three target counties against a stated goal of 15,000 women trained across Nairobi, Tana River and Nyandarua by 2028; participants are certified as Women Digital Champions after a post-training evaluation, and the organisers state that funding partners scaled back support after aid cuts, forcing a reduction in the project's original scope	ADVANCED
KenSafeSpace	Running on a EUR 1.3m EU grant	Closed after 30 months, reporting 18,000 reached directly, 9.4m through campaigns and 133 defenders trained, with a 49-member coalition continuing unfunded	CLOSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Smartphone against feature-phone connections	48.7m smartphone and 29.6m feature-phone connections, December 2025	50.2m smartphone connections, above 50m for the first time, with feature phones down to 28.5m	ADVANCED
Universal Service Fund Digital Skilling Project	None published	A Universal Service Fund project targeting 120,000 people in 19 counties over three years in unserved and underserved areas, framed by the regulator as the skills half of a connectivity programme and tied to the National Digital Master Plan 2022-2032	ADVANCED
Urban, rural and gender gaps in internet use	Did not exist	Internet penetration of 56.5% in urban areas against 25% rural, national internet use of 37.8% of men against 32.2% of women, and mobile ownership of 48.6% rural against 64.6% urban; more than 42% of women micro-entrepreneurs who own a mobile device use it mainly for personal communication rather than business	ADVANCED
Enhancing Digital Access and Community Resilience	GBP 2.3m committed, activities starting late 2025	GBP 2.3m across eight arid-lands counties including refugee-hosting Garissa and Turkana, with no completion report held	NO CHANGE
Universal Service Fund	20 sub-locations connected in FY2024/25 and 155 cumulatively, reaching about 508,012 people, with construction started at 32 of 47 planned centres of excellence	Unchanged; no FY2025/26 account published	NO CHANGE

Liberia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Internet penetration	1.84m internet users, 32.4% of a 5.67m population, with about 3.8m offline (2025-01)	No later national figure published (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Malawi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
School internet connectivity	No national school-connectivity measure before 2025-08-01; the nearest earlier statement is that over 83,000 students across 81 higher-education institutions gained cheaper connectivity through the research network	85% of Malawi's 9,000 schools have limited or no internet access and about 900 have none at all, with lack of electricity and devices named as the main barriers; the World Bank is separately supporting connection of over 200 schools	BASELINE NOT HELD
Universal Service Fund	The base carries no statement of the fund's size, income, disbursement or projects before 2025-08-01	In operation and funded from the regulator's annual budget allocation, but the Director General stated that existing funding levels remain insufficient to meet the country's connectivity needs; a school connectivity project providing computer equipment runs under the fund, and secondary-school digital-skills work is stated to draw on it. No income, balance or disbursement figure is held for any year The regulator said on 2026-08-21 that it is evaluating Universal Service Fund mechanisms to subsidise consumer devices and to fund digital-literacy work, including a proposed one-tablet-one-student programme.	BASELINE NOT HELD

Mali

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Women's digital-training target	Did not exist	Target set; no interim figure published	ADVANCED

Mauritius

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Rodrigues in the national digital strategy	Did not exist as a national commitment	A cybersecurity working framework with a Mauritius-based team and a dedicated representative, a youth awareness project, and integration of the national sign-on and super-app through post office agents, building on the regional assembly's own roadmap of 6 May 2026 (2026-05)	ADVANCED

Mozambique

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
American-funded digital inclusion and connectivity programming	In delivery	Planned and running work slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down, with no replacement funder named	REGRESSED
Gender gap in access to credit	Women 31%, men 59% (2024)	Women 34%, men 66% (2025)	REGRESSED
Subsidised smartphone programme	Did not exist	700,000 subsidised smartphones under a government-led, donor-supported programme starting at US\$5m and able to grow to US\$25m, financed through microcredit and pay-as-you-go models, alongside the 5G and 4G coverage obligations attached to the spectrum licences	ADVANCED
Financial Inclusion Index	36.4 points (2024)	36.4 points (2025), classified moderate by the central bank; Cabo Delgado rose from 23.3 to 25.8	NO CHANGE
Urban and rural information and communications technology penetration	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 80% in urban areas against about 20% in rural areas (2025-10)	Baseline not held

Namibia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Regulator sector and market report series	Published; four editions on file, the latest reporting 2023 data	Published as an irregular series - an earlier Telecommunication Sector Market Report in October 2021, the Telecommunication Sector Market Report 2021 in November 2022, the ICT Sector Market Report 2022 in December 2023 and the ICT Sector Market Report 2023 in November 2024 - built on licensees' audited financial statements and the regulator's own portal data	NO CHANGE
Schools and health facilities without adequate connectivity	339 schools and 50 health centres lacking adequate connectivity (2025-06)	No later official figure; a research council account records 65.4% of schools connected in 2023, 1,311 of 2,004	NO CHANGE, NO LATER FIGURE PUBLISHED

Niger

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Rural access constraint on identity enrolment	BASELINE NOT HELD	An analyst warns of privacy breaches, state surveillance and systemic exclusion, with rural communities, migrants and those without foundational identity most exposed	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Nigeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Device affordability	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Sub-\$100 shipments down 34% year-on-year in Q2 2026 and the African average selling price up \$41 to \$202; Nigeria's own market down 11% in the quarter	WORSENER
Digital Futures programme for young people with disabilities	Did not exist	A four-and-a-half-year programme run by a disability-rights organisation with a philanthropic foundation to expand employment access for young people with disabilities through digital skills, entrepreneurship and inclusive employment pathways, opened in Lagos with the state disability office's stated support	ADVANCED
Gender gap in identity enrolment	BASELINE NOT HELD	38.8% of enrolled NIN holders are women against 61.1% men, a 22.3-point gap (2025-06)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Rwanda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Smart-device affordability fund	A design stage with the development bank as financial intermediary, phased pilots and social-category subsidy targeting	The same design stage, with no market assessment, pilot or disbursement figure held	NO CHANGE
Universal access or service fund	In force under a presidential order of 12 May 2023, with each licensee's annual contribution capped at 2.5% of the turnover of each category of regulated service	The same; the operative rate is a regulatory-board decision not held, and the most recent accounts held remain 2020/21, when Frw 3,828,837,334 was spent against a Frw 6,372,536,516 budget	NO CHANGE
Urban and rural internet use gap	Urban usage 57%, rural 19%	Urban usage 57%, rural 19%, unchanged because unreported	NO CHANGE

Senegal

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Population without connectivity	Baseline not held	40% of the population still without access to connectivity, on the minister's statement to parliament (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Sierra Leone

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Internet penetration	20.7% of the population online, 1.84m users (2025-01)	20.8% online, 1.85m users against 7.02m offline (2025-10)	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Telecom investment against usage	BASELINE NOT HELD	About US\$400m invested against a 60% usage gap, with 1GB at Le 18,000-25,000, roughly triple the 2018 price (2026-05)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Somalia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Smartphone financing programme	Did not exist	Targeting 100,000 affordable smartphones by end-2026 at a US\$19 deposit and US\$0.60 to US\$1.60 a day, repaid over mobile money and scored on SIM tenure and spend; a pilot recorded under 4% default (2026-05)	ADVANCED

Tanzania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital transformation centre for rights and gender equity	EUR 3,000,000 committed, active	EUR 3,000,000 committed, active	NO CHANGE

Togo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Community network at Ati-Akakpe	Announced as imminent and not operating	Still only an imminent-launch announcement, with no operating record, user count or completion date	NO CHANGE

Uganda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
American-funded digital inclusion and connectivity programming	In delivery	Planned and running work slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down, with no replacement funder named	REGRESSED
Digital for Girls and Women Uganda	Active; EUR 2.25m, 2021-2025	The record still reads active; the stated period has elapsed with no closure, extension or results record held	NO CHANGE
Uganda Communications Universal Service and Access Fund	Operating; Q3 2025 outputs were 3,000 riders skilled, 4,900 tablets, laboratories in 70 secondary schools and 60 public access centres	Operating; cumulative reach stated as laboratories in more than 1,000 public secondary schools	NO CHANGE

Zimbabwe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Household computer ownership	14.2% of households (2020)	11.2% (2025); urban 21.2% against rural 4.7%	REGRESSED
Household internet access	50.1% of households (2020)	75.5% of households (2025); mobile handset ownership 96.4%, rural 94.5%, urban 99.2%	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Satellite retail service affordability	30,907 subscriptions (Q1 2025); hardware US\$350, the smaller unit US\$200, subscriptions from US\$30 a month, access reported as mostly urban	67,057 subscriptions (Q4 2025); members of parliament reported packages rising from about US\$65 to over US\$100	ADVANCED, IN SCALE ONLY; AFFORDABILITY UNCHANGED

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Women and girls digital-inclusion accelerator	BASELINE NOT HELD	An industry-body accelerator backed by two private foundations opened its next call for digital-inclusion solutions for women and girls across India and sub-Saharan Africa, with a grant amount listed at INR 42,000,000	Baseline not held

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
COMESA Regional Digital Inclusion Strategy	Did not exist	In drafting under the World Bank-supported IDEA programme, with consultation on affordable connectivity and devices, skills gaps, accessibility and digital trust; no draft, drafter or adoption date published	ADVANCED

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-26
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/include-divides/include-divides-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/include-divides/include-divides-progress-2026-08-26.pdf
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